

Person and aspect in Taushiro split ergativity*

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1. Introduction

In this paper we consider the morphosyntax of three types of case/agreement splits in Taushiro (isolate; Peru). First is a person split: subjects can be ergative only when the subject is at least as high in person as the object. Thus (1a), where both arguments are 3rd person, has an ergative subject, but an ergative subject is not possible when the object is 1st person, (1b). This is a *global* case split in that it is determined by a comparison of the two arguments' features, not simply on the basis of the subject's own properties.¹

- (1) a. i-p-untu-ke heʔi-ŋi *niji* 3 / 3
3UNACC-PFV-eat-TRANS jaguar-ERG mestizo
The jaguar has eaten the mestizo. (AGG 2023 I:240, conf.)
- b. Ø-u-p-untu heʔi *pro* 3 / 1
3SUBJ-1OBJ-PFV-eat jaguar 1PRO
The jaguar has eaten me. (AGG 2023 I:240, conf.)

Second is a split in object behavior, similarly global in nature: objects can be null only when the subject is nominative, not ergative. A null object is possible in (2a), but not (2b). We will analyze null objects, when they occur, as licensed by object clitic-doubling; thus we take this split to reflect when clitic-doubling is possible.

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¹Abbreviations: B B stem (see note 4), DISC discourse particle, ERG ergative, PFV perfective, PRO pronoun, REG regressive, TRANS transitive, UNACC unaccusative. Examples do not mark tone (see O'Hagan 2023). Citations contain speaker Amadeo García's initials, year, notebook, and page number, and a code that indicates elicitation methodology: 'trans.' = translation of a prompt; 'conf.' = produced by O'Hagan and confirmed by AGG; 'corr.' = corrected by AGG from a different utterance of O'Hagan's; 'vol.' = volunteered; 'conf. 2015 vol.' = volunteered and later reconfirmed.

- (2) a. Ø-i-p-untu heʔi pro 3 / 2
 3SUBJ-2OBJ-PFV-eat jaguar 2PRO
 The jaguar has eaten you. (AGG 2023 I:240, conf.)
- b. i-p-untu-ke u-ŋi ii 1 / 2
 2OBJ-PFV-eat-TRANS 1-ERG 2PRO
 I’ve eaten you. (AGG 2023 I:240, trans.)

Last, we find an aspect split of a familiar sort: subjects can be ergative only when aspect is [PERFECTIVE], (3). The three splits are summarized in (4).

- (3) a. ta=h-Ø-oʔçi ui ahuntu Non-PFV
 DISC=1SUBJ-3OBJ-shoot 1PRO woolly.monkey
 I’m shooting the woolly monkey. (AGG 2023 I:207, conf.)
- b. i-ç-oʔçi-cçi u-ŋi ahuntu PFV
 3UNACC-PFV-shoot-TRANS 1-ERG woolly.monkey
 I’ve already shot the woolly monkey. (ibid.)

- (4) Three splits in Taushiro

	A ≥ O in person	A < O in person
Non perfective	A.NOM, O clitic-doubles	A.NOM, O clitic-doubles
Perfective	A.ERG, O merely agrees	A.NOM, O clitic-doubles

We will show that the seeming globality of these patterns is no obstacle for a strictly local theory where both case and agreement reflect Agree. The key tools will be dependent case by Agree (Clem and Deal To appear) and case sensitivity/case discrimination, which behaves distinctly for pure agreement vs. for clitic-doubling (Deal 2025a). In §2, we discuss perfective aspect, then DP behavior in non-perfective clauses. We then discuss case and agreement in perfective transitives (§3). In §4 we analyze the global person split for ergative case following Clem and Deal (To appear). Clitic-doubling is taken up in §5, which concludes with derivations for ergative and non-ergative clauses.

We note as contextualization of this work that Taushiro is both an understudied and highly endangered language. Publicly available descriptive work is limited to Alicea Ortiz (1975a,b,c), Pérez Ríos (2008), O’Hagan (2023). As of 2025, Amadeo García García (b. abt. 1949) is considered by himself and others to be the last fluent speaker. This work is based on four weeks of fieldwork by O’Hagan with García in Iquitos, Peru in 2015 and 2023. Aspects of our empirical understanding that remain incomplete will be noted.

2. Taushiro basics: aspect, non-perfective clauses

Taushiro distinguishes both tense (future vs. nonfuture) and aspect; the aspect inventory includes at least imperfective, habitual, and perfective.² We use ‘perfective’ to describe the aspect used in translations of Spanish past-tense verbs with *ya* ‘already’ and/or with *terminar de X* ‘finish X-ing.’³ This aspect triggers a distinctive case/agreement alignment,

²Aspect may also be left unmarked. The semantics of unmarked aspect require further study.

³We remain neutral as to the precise semantics of this aspect; the term ‘perfective’ is provisional.

as seen in (3). Perfective is expounded by a prefix for vowel-initial roots, (5), or palatalization for /k/-initial roots, (6). It is otherwise zero-marked, (7).⁴

- | | |
|---|---|
| <p>(5) uçaʔtēwa ui
 u-ç-aʔtēwa ui
 1SUBJ-PFV-sit.down 1PRO
 I've already sat down.
 (AGG 2023 I:75, trans.)</p> | <p>(6) iʔççoho aʔtuakitu
 i-Ø_{PAL}-koho aʔtua-kitu
 3UNACC-PFV-hatch chicken-egg
 The chicken egg already hatched.
 (AGG 2023 I:188, conf.)⁵</p> |
| <p>(7) iʔk^wiçi honto
 i-Ø-k^wiçi honto
 3UNACC-PFV-light fire
 The fire has been lit. (AGG 2023 I:166, corr.)</p> | |

We now describe case and agreement in non-perfective clauses. Subjects agree via verbal prefixes. Local persons use the same agreement forms as subjects (of all predicates, transitive and intransitive) and objects: first person *u-*, second person *i-*.⁶

- | | |
|--|--|
| <p>(8) a. u-wino=ro ui
 1SUBJ-wake.up=REG 1PRO
 I woke up. (AGG 2023 I:190, corr.)</p> | <p>b. u-tiʔti ui
 1SUBJ-run 1PRO
 I ran. (AGG 2023 I:199, conf.)</p> |
| <p>(9) a. i-wino=ro ii
 2SUBJ-wake.up=REG 2PRO
 You woke up. (AGG 2023 I:190, conf.)</p> | <p>b. i-tiʔti ii
 2SUBJ-run 2PRO
 You ran.</p> |
| <p>(10) a. u-i-kwi ui <i>pro</i>
 1SUBJ-2OBJ-cut 1PRO 2PRO
 I cut you. (AGG 2023 I:160, conf.)</p> | <p>b. i-u-kwi ii <i>pro</i>
 2SUBJ-1OBJ-cut 2PRO 1PRO
 You cut me. (AGG 2023 I:160, conf.)</p> |

Third person agreement shows more distinctions, including a cut between two classes of intransitive predicates ('Split-S'). Third person unaccusative subjects show a distinctive agreement form, *i-* (homophonous with 2nd person), (11). By contrast, 3rd person unergative (12) and transitive (13) subjects control no overt agreement. We gloss a null morpheme.

- | | |
|--|---|
| <p>(11) a. i-wino nacço
 3UNACC-wake.up 3.PRO
 He woke up. (*wino nacço)
 (AGG 2023 II:4, corr.)</p> | <p>b. i-ç-uʔka=ro iço
 3UNACC-PFV-come=REG rain
 The rain has already passed.
 (AGG 2023 I:174, trans.)</p> |
|--|---|

⁴The perfective can also be identified in some cases by a special stem it triggers, involving addition of a final copy vowel (/ʔ/-final roots) or truncation of /hV/ (/hV_[+FRONT]/-final roots).

⁵The glottal stop appearing between the prefix and the root in (6), (7) is preliminarily analyzed as prosodically conditioned. Certain other examples exhibit glottal stops not visible in the segmentation.

⁶Both first person *u-* and second person *i-* show pre-vocalic gliding, *u* to *w* and *i* to *j*; we do not represent this here. *u-* additionally changes to *h-* before round vowels, as in (3a). We leave open whether these patterns represent (morpheme-specific) allomorphy or rather language-wide phonological patterns.

- (12) a. Ø-tiʔti nacço
3SUBJ-run 3PRO
He ran. (AGG 2023 I:199, conf.)
- b. Ø-kwaçoʔko nacço
3SUBJ-jump 3PRO
He jumped. (AGG 2023 I:195, conf.)
- (13) ta=Ø-u-çcio-ne nacço *pro*
DISC=3SUBJ-1OBJ-pinch-IPFV 3PRO 1PRO
He's pinching me. (AGG 2023 I:209, trans.)

Contrary to more familiar split intransitive systems, third person objects do not agree like unaccusative subjects. Rather, third person objects control a distinctive prefixal paradigm: *a-* __C, Ø- __V. The overall system for 3rd person inflection is shown in (15).

- (14) a. ta=u-[a]-kuʔko ui honto
DISC=1SUBJ-3OBJ-fan 1PRO fire
I'm fanning the fire. (AGG 2023 I:192, conf.)
- b. i-[a]-kwiçi ii honto
2SUBJ-3OBJ-stoke 2PRO fire
Stoke the fire! (AGG 2023 I:81, trans.)
- c. ta=u-[Ø]-iʔtu ui taja
DISC=1SUBJ-3OBJ-chase.off 1PRO white.lipped.peccary
I chased off the white-lipped peccary. (AGG 2023 I:120, vol.)

- (15) Third person prefixes

	External argument	Internal argument
Intransitive	Ø- (S _{UNERG})	i- (S _{UNACC})
Transitive	Ø- (A)	a- (O)

As various examples above suggest already, non-perfective clauses show no case marking on either subject or object. This is further demonstrated in (16).

- (16) a. ta=u-a-kuʔ ui_A nuʔwi_O
DISC=1SUBJ-3OBJ-burn 1PRO meat
I'm scorching the meat. (AGG 2023 I:101, conf. 2015 vol.)
- b. ta=Ø-a-xina ijō_A anowa_O anacçiō
DISC=3SUBJ-3OBJ-make mother.1P cushma right.now
My mother is making a *cushma* right now. (AGG 2023 I:140, trans.)
- c. ta=Ø-u-çcio-ne nacço_A *pro*
DISC=3SUBJ-1OBJ-pinch-IPFV 3PRO 1PRO
He's pinching me. (AGG 2023 I:209, trans.)

An important asymmetry between subjects and objects in non-perfective clauses concerns their ability to be null. Subjects cannot be null in Taushiro; we take this to indicate that the language does not freely permit *pro*-drop. (This holds also in perfective aspect.)

- (17) ta-u-Ø-aʔnta *(ui) aʔççaʔ
DISC=1SUBJ-3OBJ-extinguish 1PRO lantern
I'm extinguishing the lantern. (AGG 2023 I:119, corr.)

Objects, by contrast, can and in some cases must be null. In particular, local person objects cannot be expressed with overt pronouns in object position, as shown in (18).

- (18) a. ta=i-u-çcio-ne ii *pro* / *ui
DISC=2SUBJ-1OBJ-pinch-IPFV 2PRO 1PRO / *1PRO_(overt)
You're pinching me. (AGG 2023 II:7, corr.)
- b. ta=Ø-i-çcio-ne naço *pro* / *ii
DISC=3SUBJ-2OBJ-pinch-IPFV 3PRO 2PRO / *2PRO_(overt)
He's pinching you. (ibid.)

While this distribution may seem puzzling when viewed as simply *pro*-drop, we suggest it receives a natural analysis if object prefixes but not subject prefixes arise syntactically via clitic-doubling. We hypothesize in particular that (a) Taushiro requires objects to be clitic-doubled, and (b) clitic-doubling of local person pronouns requires the in-situ DP to be *pro*. The latter requirement is familiar from languages like French, where clitics require *pro* associates; the former requirement is familiar from work positing that “object agreement” (though not subject agreement) is in fact clitic-doubling in the syntax (e.g., Kramer 2014). Taushiro provides an interesting new data point for this literature because it uses the very same prefix forms for subjects and objects in local persons, first person *u*- and second person *i*-. This suggests that these markers reflect highly underspecified VIs (insensitive to the syntactic difference between agreement and clitic-doubling) and provides support for the claim that morphophonological behaviors of ϕ markers are inadequate to differentiate agreement from clitic-doubling (Akkus et al. 2024, i.a.).

3. Perfective transitives and the global split ergative pattern

Transitive clauses in the perfective show a global split in subject case and object drop (see (4)). To demonstrate this pattern, we begin with examples where the subject is lower in person than the object ($A < O$), in particular 3A/1O and 3A/2O, (19). Here, we see the general pattern familiar from non-perfective aspect. Subjects are in unmarked case and show their typical agreement pattern (here Ø- for 3rd person). Objects clitic-double: they are indexed on the verb via prefixes but do not appear overtly in object position.

- (19) a. Ø-u-ŋ-untu heʔi *pro* 3 / 1
 3SUBJ-1OBJ-PFV-eat jaguar 1PRO
 The jaguar has eaten me. (AGG 2023 I:240, conf.)
 b. Ø-i-ŋ-untu heʔi *pro* 3 / 2
 3SUBJ-2OBJ-PFV-eat jaguar 2PRO
 The jaguar has eaten you. (AGG 2023 I:240, conf.)

We contrast this with the situation when (still in the perfective) the subject is as high or higher in person than the object ($A \geq O$), in particular in 1A/2O, 1A/3O, 2A/3O, and 3A/3O. In these environments we see the four properties in (20):

- (20) Four properties of ergative clauses
- a. Subjects bear ergative *-ŋi* (+allomorphs, e.g., nasalization)

- b. The verb takes suffix *-ke* (*-cɛi* after front vowels)
- c. Subject agreement is lost
- d. Objects are agreed-with, not clitic-doubled (pronominal objects must be overt); agreement uses the unaccusative subject form

These properties are demonstrated in (21). For property (20c), note there is no *u-* for the first person subject in (21a) and (21b), nor *i-* for the second person subject in (21c). For property (20d), note that the second person object is overt in (21a), which we take to indicate that it has *not* been clitic-doubled (contrast the second person object in (19b)). Note also that third person objects show agreement in the form otherwise reserved for unaccusative subjects, as seen in (21c) and (21d); contrast the *a-* form seen for third person objects in nonperfective clauses, e.g., (16a,b).

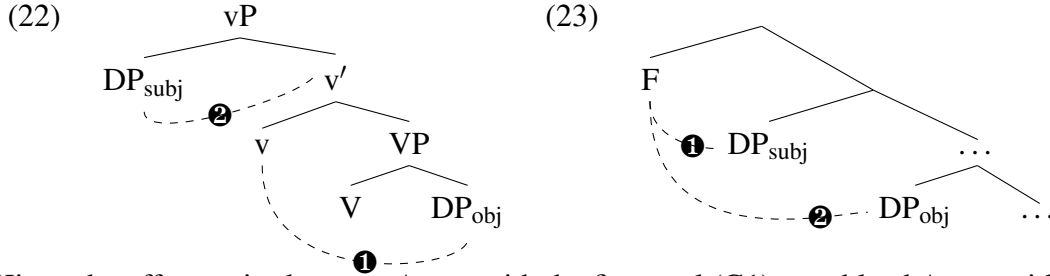
- | | | | | | |
|------|----|---|------------|---------|-------|
| (21) | a. | i-n-untu-ke | u-ŋi | ii | 1 / 2 |
| | | 2OBJ-PFV-eat-TRANS | 1-ERG | 2PRO | |
| | | I've finished eating you. (AGG 2023 I:240, trans.) | | | |
| | b. | i-j-u?na-ke | u-ŋi | a?tua | 1 / 3 |
| | | 3UNACC-PFV-defeather-TRANS | 1-ERG | chicken | |
| | | I've already defeathered the chicken. (AGG 2023 I:191, conf.) | | | |
| | c. | i-n-untu-ke=hã | i-ŋi | he?i | 2 / 3 |
| | | 3UNACC-PFV-eat-TRANS=INT | 2-ERG | jaguar | |
| | | Have you finished eating the jaguar? (AGG 2023 I:240, vol.) | | | |
| | d. | i-n-untu-ke | he?i-ŋi | niji | 3 / 3 |
| | | 3UNACC-PFV-eat-TRANS | jaguar-ERG | mestizo | |
| | | The jaguar has finished eating the mestizo. (AGG 2023 I:240, conf.) | | | |

We have described the split in terms of a person hierarchy: ergative happens when $A \geq O$ in person, not otherwise. The one combination missing in our data is 2A/1O. The behavior of this particular person combination stands to differentiate between two potential forms of a person hierarchy active here, which can be described in terms of the nature of the scale at play. One option is that the relevant scale is $LOCAL > 3$. First and second person are both $LOCAL$, and when A and O are equal on the scale ergative appears, so 2/1 should have ergative. This would make for a pattern akin to weak PCC (a pattern where, for the standard realization of a ditransitive, $IO \geq DO$ on the scale $LOCAL > 3$). The other option is that the relevant scale is $1 > 2 > 3$. Since second person is lower than first person on this scale, and when $A < O$ there is no ergative, 2/1 should *not* have ergative. This would make for a pattern akin to strictly descending ('ultrastrong') PCC (a pattern where, for the standard realization of a ditransitive, $IO \geq DO$ on the scale $1 > 2 > 3$).

4. Capturing the global person split in the distribution of ergative

Analyses of person hierarchy effects in the recent literature converge on the idea that these effects arise from Agree, in particular in contexts when one probe can potentially Agree with two goals. Clem and Deal (To appear) argue on this basis that dependent case assignment reflects Agree: person hierarchy effects arise crosslinguistically in the determination

of both ergative and accusative case. They propose that dependent cases appear on the *second* goal to Agree with a probe (see also Poole 2024). Ergative arises when the transitive subject is the second goal. A probe on *v* Agrees with the object and then the subject (as per Cyclic Agree; Rezac 2003, Béjar and Rezac 2009), (22). Accusative arises when a probe above both arguments Agrees with the subject and then the object, (23).



Hierarchy effects arise because Agree with the first goal (G1) may bleed Agree with a second goal (G2). On an interaction and satisfaction approach (Deal 2015, 2024, 2025b), this could be for two reasons. First, it could be that G1 **satisfies** the probe, causing probing to halt. Second, it could be that G1 **dynamically interacts** with the probe, changing its interaction specification in a way that prevents Agree with G2 (see esp. Deal 2024). Regardless of the reason, if G2 cannot Agree, it does not surface with dependent case. In what follows, we gloss over the particular treatment of case features in Clem and Deal (To appear) and simply assume a second goal receives [ERG] or [ACC].

Clem and Deal’s analysis applies straightforwardly to Taushiro (on either the strictly descending PCC or the weak PCC generalization). In this language, a probe on *v* potentially Agrees with both the object (first) and the subject (second). As in Deal (2024), a “weak PCC” pattern involves dynamic interaction of the feature [PART] (and a probe that is insatiable, [SAT:-]); a “strictly descending” pattern adds satisfaction by the feature [SPKR]. We begin with the data amenable to either analysis. First, ergative always occurs when the object is 3rd person:

(24) 3O: the patterns

Subject	Object	Ergative pattern	Example number
1	3	Y	(21b)
2	3	Y	(21c)
3	3	Y	(21d)

A third person object neither satisfies the probe nor dynamically interacts with it; the probe thus always Agrees with the subject via cyclic expansion, regardless of the subject’s person. Since the subject is the second goal, it is marked with ergative case. The derivation of a *vP* of this type is shown in (22) above. We show this derivation in a different format in (25), anticipating the discussion below of dynamic interaction. When *v* is merged, Agree takes place, targeting the object, (25a). The subject is then merged, (25b). Following Rezac (2003) and Béjar and Rezac (2009), probe information on *v* is projected to *v'*; the two behave identically *qua* probes. Thus *v'*, sharing the same probe as *v*, is able to Agree with the subject, which it c-commands, (25c). This is the second Agree goal for the *v* probe overall,

and so ergative is assigned. Which particular ϕ features the subject bears is irrelevant here; it will always receive ergative case.

- (25) a. $[_{v'} \ v_{[INT:\phi]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi]}]]$ Agreement with the object
 {-----Agree-----}
 b. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:\phi]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi]}]]]$ Subject merged
 c. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:\phi]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi]}]]]$ Subject Agrees
 {-----Agree; ERG-----}

Turning to second person objects, ergative occurs only when the subject is first person, not third person. We will model this as a case where only the first person can Agree, but not the third person. This is because, unlike in (25), the object bears the feature $[PART]$, which interacts dynamically. We annotate this feature with $\uparrow$ to indicate its dynamic behavior.

(26) 2O: the patterns

Subject	Object	Ergative pattern	Example number
1	2	Y	(21a)
3	2	N	(19b)

If the subject is third person (and so lacks $[PART]$), it will not interact with v and there will be no ergative case. This derivation is shown in (27), which differs from (25) in its second step: after the probe on v Agrees with the $[PART\uparrow]$ -bearing object, the probe's interaction condition changes to $[PART]$. This makes the probe unable to interact with the subject, which lacks $[PART]$. Since the subject cannot Agree, it does not receive $[ERG]$ in (19b).

- (27) a. $[_{v'} \ v_{[INT:\phi]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi,PART\uparrow]}]]$ Agreement with the object
 {-----Agree-----}
 b. $[_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi,PART\uparrow]}]]$ Probe update
 c. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi,PART\uparrow]}]]]$ Subject merged
 d. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi,PART\uparrow]}]]]$ No Agree!
 {-----X-----}

In contrast, if the subject is first person (i.e., bearing $[PART]$), it will interact with v and be marked ergative, (21a). Derivation (28) is exactly like (27) save for the subject's features. Because the subject has $[PART]$, it successfully Agrees in the final step, yielding ergative.

- (28) a. $[_{v'} \ v_{[INT:\phi]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi,PART\uparrow]}]]$ Agreement with the object
 {-----Agree-----}
 b. $[_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi,PART\uparrow]}]]$ Probe update
 c. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi,PART,SPKR]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi,PART\uparrow]}]]]$ Subj merged
 d. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi,PART,SPKR]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi,PART\uparrow]}]]]$ Agree!
 {-----Agree; ERG-----}

Lastly, we turn to first person objects, where we have a data gap. We do know that there is no ergative in 3/1, and this is expected: Agree with the subject is ruled out by dynamic interaction just like in (27).

(29) 1O: the patterns

Subject	Object	Ergative pattern	Example number
3	1	N	(19a)
2	1	?	

The two options for the missing data point, 2/1, reflect the question of probe's satisfaction conditions. Thus far we treated the probe as insatiable. If this is correct, we expect ergative in 2/1 (the weak PCC pattern).

(30) Deriving 2/1 (weak PCC option)

- a. $[_{v'} \ v_{[INT:\phi]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi, PART\uparrow, SPKR]}]]$
└──────────────────┘
- b. $[_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi, PART\uparrow, SPKR]}]]$
- c. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi, PART]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi, PART\uparrow, SPKR]}]]]$
- d. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi, PART]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi, PART\uparrow, SPKR]}]]]$
└──────────┘
Agree; ERG

If, by contrast, we model the probe as [SAT:SPKR], we expect no ergative in 2/1: the strictly descending pattern. The derivation in (31) departs from those above in making use of a satisfaction condition for the probe. When the probe Agrees with the object, which bears the feature [SPKR], probing is halted. There is no further step of Agree possible after the subject is merged, regardless of the subject's features.

(31) Deriving 2/1 (strictly descending PCC option)

- a. $[_{v'} \ v_{[INT:\phi, SAT:SPKR]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi, PART\uparrow, SPKR]}]]$
└──────────────────┘
- b. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi, PART]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART, SAT:SPKR]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi, PART\uparrow, SPKR]}]]]$
- c. $[_{VP} \ DP_{[\phi, PART]} \ [_{v'} \ v_{[INT:PART, SAT:SPKR]} \ [_{VP} \ V \ DP_{[\phi, PART\uparrow, SPKR]}]]]$
└───┘
✗

To summarize, we have shown in this section how the global person split can be captured by bringing together two ideas. First, hierarchy effects arise when Agree with a first goal bleeds Agree with a second goal. Second, ergative case is a distinctive behavior of second v-Agree goals. We note as well that the derivations discussed in this section give a straightforward approach to the *-ke* suffix that occurs iff the subject is ergative:

- (32) i-j-untu-**ke** u-ŋi ii 1 / 2
 2OBJ-PFV-eat-TRANS 1-ERG 2PRO
 I've eaten you. (AGG 2023 I:240, trans.)

We suggest that *-ke* is the realization of v itself when it has Agreed with two arguments. This follows a proposal by Deal and Royer (To appear) for Mayan set A: it expones v's features when v Agrees with two goals. From this perspective, the *-ke* suffix could be thought of as extremely underspecified ergative-specific agreement.

Our approach thus far accounts for why ergative is confined to one particular cell of our person/aspect table in (4). The role of person reflects the Agree behaviors of a *v* probe: only when *v* is able to Agree with both *O* and *A* does ergative case/agreement appear. The role of aspect reflects the distribution of the relevant probe over different clausal structures: only in the perfective do we find the relevant *v* probe. From the list of properties in (20), it remains to account for differences in agreement and clitic-doubling between ergative and non-ergative clauses. Specifically, non-ergative subjects agree with the verb, whereas ergative subjects do not; in non-ergative clauses, objects clitic-double, whereas in ergative clauses, they merely Agree. We suggest that these effects reflect case sensitivity for Agree (i.e., “case discrimination” or “case targeting”), a behavior known to interact with pure agreement vs. clitic-doubling in distinctive ways.

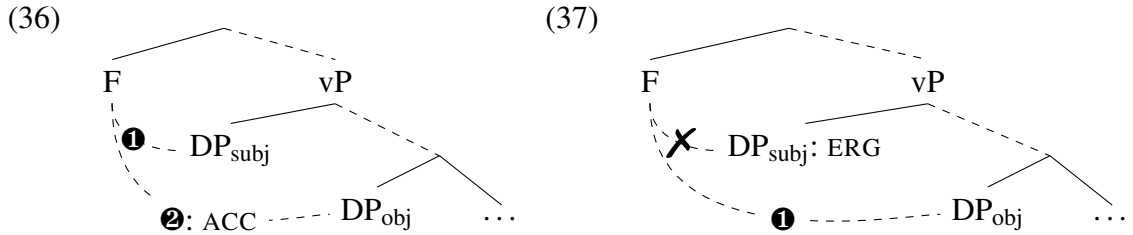
(33) i-j-uʔna-ke u-ŋjɪ aʔtua
3UNACC-PFV-defeather-TRANS 1-ERG chicken
I've already defeathered the chicken. (AGG 2023 I:191, conf.)

- (34) [T ...[_{vP} Subject: ERG [_{v'} ...Obj]]
-----Agree-----

To capture the behavior of objects for clitic-doubling, we make two proposals. First, Taushiro objects differ in their abstract case. The object in (34) is abstractly nominative, enabling T to Agree with it. We suggest that some Taushiro objects are abstractly accusative, where accusative is a dependent case. In line with the general pattern that dependent accusative only occurs (on G2) if the case competitor (G1) is in nominative case, we propose that Taushiro shows the two transitive case arrays in (35).

- (35) Two transitive case arrays in Taushiro
- | | A | O |
|-----------------------------|-----|-----|
| a. PFV aspect, $A \geq O$: | ERG | NOM |
| b. Otherwise: | NOM | ACC |

To capture this pattern, we assume as above that dependent accusative case appears on the second goal of a higher probe (F), and that Agree is again case-sensitive; this probe is not able to Agree with ergatives. When the subject is not ergative, (36), the object is the second goal, and receives accusative. But when the subject is ergative, (37), the object is merely the *first* goal, and no accusative is assigned.



Our second proposal falls at the intersection of case-sensitivity and clitic-doubling. Literature on clitic-doubling (CD) has proposed that CD-probes can target elements in specific cases (Sportiche 1996, Arregi and Nevins 2012, Akkuş et al. 2024, Paparounas and Salzmann 2023, i.a.); this targeting does *not* obey the case-sensitivity hierarchy posited by Bobaljik (2008). Deal (2025a) argues that CD in fact obeys the opposite hierarchy as does pure agreement: oblique case nominals (e.g., datives) are more likely to sponsor CD than are accusative or ergatives, which in turn are more likely to sponsor CD than are nominatives or absolutes. Given our treatment of objects in non-ergative clauses as abstractly accusative, the Taushiro data are in line with this proposal: only accusatives can clitic-double. Thus the head driving object CD in Taushiro must thus be merged above where ACC is determined. For simplicity, below, we show the CD probe on T (meaning T hosts two probes with opposite case sensitivity behavior; cp. Paparounas and Salzmann 2023).

Putting the pieces together, we now provide complete derivations for ergative and non-ergative clauses. First, the non-ergative pattern, e.g., (38). We seek to explain the unmarked case of the subject, the agreement of the subject, and the clitic-doubling of the object.

- (38) u-i-kwi ui pro
1SUBJ-2OBJ-cut 1PRO 2PRO
I cut you. (AGG 2023 I:160, conf.)

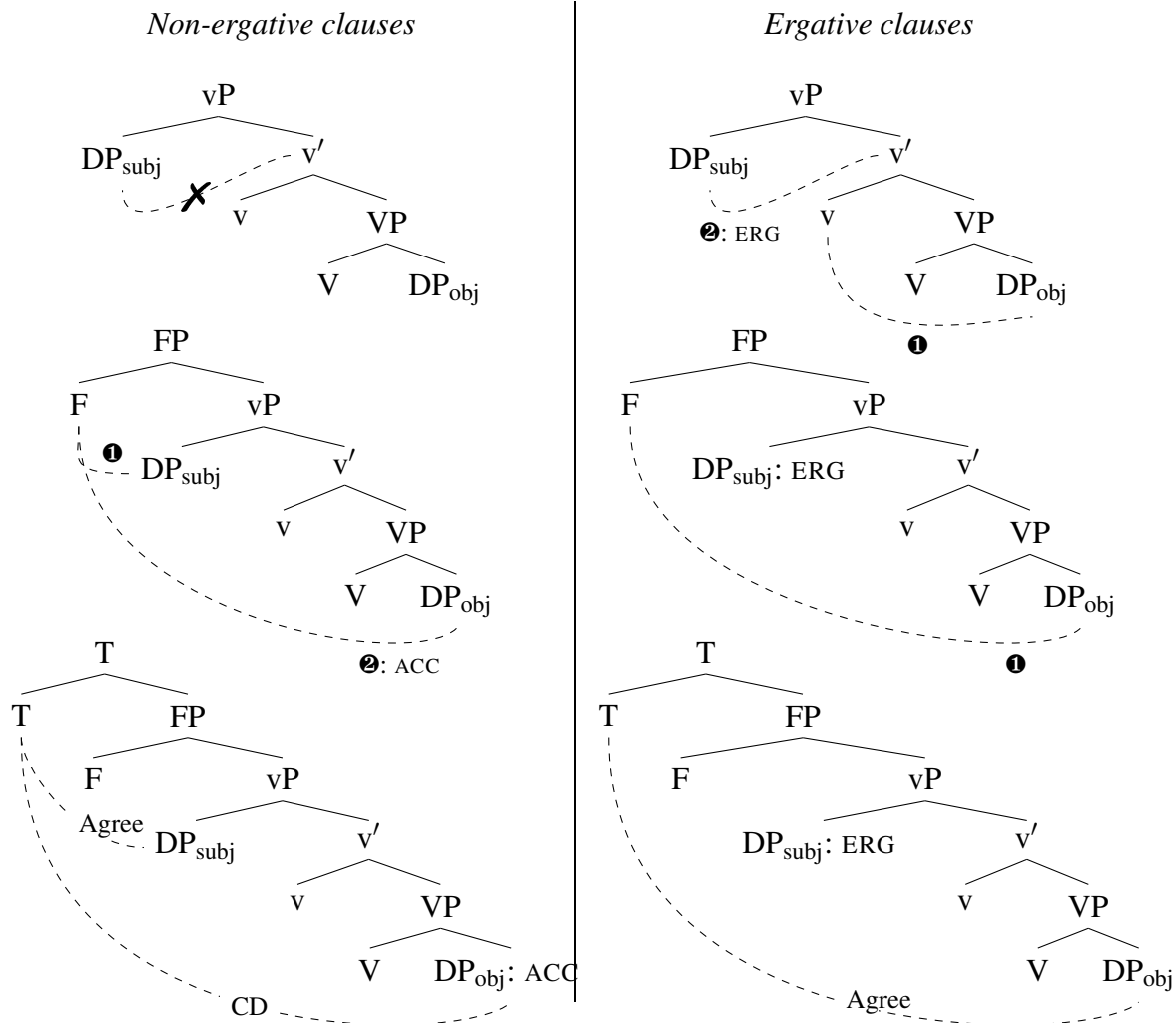


Figure 1: Case, agreement, and clitic-doubling: overview

The derivation is shown in the left column of Figure 1. At the vP level, *v* does not Agree with the subject. This could be because *v* lacks a probe (as in non-perfective examples like (38)) or because Agree with the object bleeds this possibility (as in perfective examples where $A < O$.) Either way, no ERG is assigned (see the top left tree, Figure 1). This has a consequence when *F* is merged and Agrees (middle left tree). *F* Agrees with the non-ergative subject and then with the object, making the object a second goal and assigning it accusative. Finally, *T* is merged (bottom left tree), bearing a CD probe that targets accusatives and a simple Agree probe that targets nominatives.

Turning next to the ergative pattern, we seek to explain the ergative case of the subject, the *-ke* suffix on the verb, the absence of subject agreement, the presence of (pure) agreement with the object, and the absence of object clitic-doubling. These behaviors are exemplified in (39). The derivation is shown in the right column of Figure 1. At the vP level, *v* Agrees with the object and then the subject (top right tree). This has two results: since the subject is a second goal for the probe, dependent case is assigned (ERG); and the

double set of features on the *v* head is spelled out as the suffix *-ke*. At the FP level, *F* Agrees only with the object, as the subject's ergative case renders it unsuitable for agreement. The object is merely a first Agree goal and no ACC is assigned (center right tree). Last, at the TP level, the subject remains unavailable as an Agree goal due to its ergative case; the *T* probe therefore Agrees with the (unmarked) object (bottom right tree).

- (39) i-ɲ-untu-ke u-ŋi ii
 2OBJ-PFV-eat-TRANS 1-ERG 2PRO
 I've eaten you. (AGG 2023 I:240, trans.)

6. Conclusions

We have discussed an alignment split that appears quite global both in the conditioning environment (subject *and* object features matter) and in the scope of its effects across the clause (case, agreement, verb marking, null arguments). Our aim was to show that this type of system follows straightforwardly from existing theories of case and agreement, in particular those based on Agree. Taushiro furnishes a new example of a person-based global ergative split of the sort predicted by Clem and Deal (To appear). Dependent-case assignment shows PCC/hierarchy effects, exactly like other Agree-based phenomena; this provides further evidence that dependent case is more closely connected to Agree(ment) than envisioned on “configurational” case theories (e.g., Baker 2015). Taushiro also provides new evidence that case-sensitivity for Agree behaves quite distinctly when Agree triggers clitic-doubling; when it does, it is *marked* cases rather than unmarked ones that are preferential Agree targets (Deal 2025a). From this perspective, a question that remains open is why accusatives in particular undergo clitic-doubling whereas ergatives do not.

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